Ford Motor Company

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Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
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July 2002

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 02S38: Certain 2002 Model Year Thunderbird Vehicles Seat Belt

REF: Dealer Announcement dated June 14, 2002, Informational Safety Recall Communication

REF: Dealer Announcement dated 10/26/01, Special Handling Procedure

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2002 Model Year Thunderbird vehicles built at the Wixom Assembly Plant from the beginning of production through April 24, 2002.

SAFETY CONCERN

During a New Car Assessment Program 35 mph frontal barrier impact test of a 2002 Thunderbird conducted by the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA), the driver side seat belt was partially cut by the seat mechanism. The seat belt did not completely separate and the test dummy was restrained by the seat belt throughout the test.

SERVICE ACTION

Ford wants to add an insert, which will not be visible, to the driver seat lower trim to eliminate the potential for the seat belt to contact the seat mechanism in a severe collision as simulated in the NHTSA 35 mph frontal barrier impact test.

CUSTOMER NOTIFICATION

Owners of record were notified beginning the week of June 21, 2002 of this action and advised to contact their dealer after July 15, 2002 when parts are expected to be available at dealerships.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

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SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all Thunderbird owners affected by this program. Please see dealer announcement dated 10/26/01, Special Handling Procedure. This special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer owners convenient vehicle handling.

Ford Motor is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for our Thunderbird customers, many of whom are new to the Ford family.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter(s)

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……..……...1-800-423-8851
Online Involved Unit Listings ……1-800-555-9601
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Frank M. Ligon

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Safety Recall 02S38
Certain 2002 Thunderbird Vehicles
Seat Belt

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Online Involved Unit Listing available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other affected vehicles identified in OASIS which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Note: Owners should receive the "Special Handling Procedure". To familiarize yourself, please review "Special Handling Procedure" before calling customers.

Immediately contact any of your affected owners whose names are not on your VIN list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

Note: These dealer listings may contain customer names and addresses obtained from Motor Vehicle Registration Records. The use of such motor vehicle registration data for any purpose other than in connection with this recall is a violation of law in several states/provinces/countries. Accordingly, you must limit the use of this listing to the follow-up necessary to complete this action.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

To claim for "Special Handling", follow the instructions on page two of dealer announcement dated 10/26/01.

OWNER REFUNDS

Not Applicable.

RENTAL CARS

See "Special Handling Guidelines" for claiming a rental vehicle under this program.

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Certain 2002 Thunderbird vehicles
Seat Belt

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
*Install an insert on driver side lower seat trim	02S38B	0.6 Hours
Special Handling:	Misc. Expense Code "SCHP"	See Special Handling
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

*PLEASE NOTE: **The procedure in this bulletin is not the same as published workshop manual procedures that include removal of the seat cushion lower seat trim. Removal of the seat, disconnecting of the seat wiring harness and the air bag deactivation/reactivation procedure is not necessary.**

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Expect parts to be arriving in depots the week of July 1, 2002. Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels as noted below:

All Orders	Through July 21	Call 1-800-325-5621
All Orders	After July 22	Normal order process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
1W6Z-7662187-BA	Insert Assembly	1

ORDER INFORMATION

The DOR/COR for this program is **50283**. This number identifies parts ordered for this recall through the Special Service Support Center (1-800-325-5621).

PARTS RETENTION

Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for “Parts Retention and Return Procedures”.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to DOES II or updated price book.

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

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